

She and Bill had begun talking seriously about their plans after graduation. They knew they would get married, but beyond that had no definite plans for what they would do. Bill was earning a degree in music, and Andrea's degree in elementary education required her to intern for at least three months. Then her employment would depend on finding an opening in the school system near the college. Bill wanted to go on to graduate school and gain his master's degree so he could teach music at the college level.

During the next three months, Andrea fell into a routine of using her mother's credit card periodically to take Bill out to eat and buy him gifts. Then she had the brakes fixed on her car, again using the card. Without realizing it she began to develop a habit of small indulgences, using her mother's card to pay for them. None were particularly significant by themselves, but when totaled, they began to add up. The bills came to her mother's home, where she put them unopened on her desk; she just couldn't cope with the details of daily life yet.

Suddenly school was coming to an end and Andrea was faced with entering the workforce for the first time, which made her feel a bit panicky. She thought more and more about getting married. She feared that if they waited until summer, something might happen to keep them from getting married. That thought really shook her. She had lost her father; she couldn't stand the thought of possibly losing Bill too.

One evening she said to Bill, "Why don't we go ahead and get married? I know Mom is in no shape to take on a wedding, and I'm not sure she could emotionally handle seeing me get married anyway."

"But how will we make it financially?" Bill asked. "Neither of us has a job, and you still have your student teaching to complete."

"We already have my apartment," Andrea replied, "and without your dorm fee our expenses would actually be less, wouldn't they?"

"Well, I guess so," he replied as he thought about the idea. "But I don't know if my dad would continue to pay my bills if I got